



# **RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION (RHT) PROGRAM:**

## **A GUIDE TO STATE AWARDEE REPORTING**

## Table of Contents

|                                                                           |           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>I. Introduction.....</b>                                               | <b>2</b>  |
| <b>II. RHT Program Reporting Requirements .....</b>                       | <b>3</b>  |
| <b>III. Reporting Cadence &amp; Periods .....</b>                         | <b>3</b>  |
| <b>IV. Annual, Quarterly, and Final Reports .....</b>                     | <b>3</b>  |
| Annual Reporting.....                                                     | 3         |
| Quarterly Reporting .....                                                 | 4         |
| Final Report .....                                                        | 4         |
| <b>V. Reporting Elements .....</b>                                        | <b>4</b>  |
| <b>VI. Completing Your Reports .....</b>                                  | <b>5</b>  |
| <b>VII. Getting Started – Submitting Your Initial Annual Report .....</b> | <b>6</b>  |
| Instructions.....                                                         | 6         |
| 1. Initiative Forms .....                                                 | 7         |
| 2. State Policy Actions Form.....                                         | 11        |
| 3. Obligated and Spent Funds Reporting Tabs .....                         | 14        |
| 4. Additional Information Form .....                                      | 14        |
| 5. Submitting Evidentiary Documentation.....                              | 16        |
| 6. Submitting Your Initial Annual Report.....                             | 17        |
| <b>VIII. Subsequent Reporting - MDCT RHTP Platform.....</b>               | <b>18</b> |
| Instructions.....                                                         | 18        |
| 1. General Information .....                                              | 19        |
| 2. Initiative Attachments.....                                            | 20        |
| 3. Initiatives .....                                                      | 26        |
| 4. State Policy Commitments.....                                          | 32        |
| 5. Use of Funds Reporting .....                                           | 33        |
| 6. Sustainability and Highlights.....                                     | 35        |
| 7. Review & Submit .....                                                  | 37        |
| <b>IX. Appendix .....</b>                                                 | <b>39</b> |
| A. Reporting Periods – Annual and Quarterly Reporting.....                | 39        |

|                                                                     |    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| B. Resources .....                                                  | 39 |
| C. State Progress Reporting Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) ..... | 40 |
| Reporting Submission Process (Initial Annual Reporting) .....       | 40 |
| Evidentiary Documentation .....                                     | 40 |
| State Reporting Non-Compliance.....                                 | 40 |
| D. Table of Figures .....                                           | 41 |

# I. Introduction

As partners in a Cooperative Agreement, we have a shared goal: the success of your State's Rural Health Transformation (RHT) Program. Your core responsibility is to comply with all Terms and Conditions in your Notice of Award (NoA). Here's what that looks like in practice:

- ✓ **Fulfilling Requirements:** Submit all required reporting as detailed in your NoA.
- ✓ **Managing Your Work Plan:** Submit performance measures as agreed upon and submit subsequent revisions to your work plan for CMS approval.
- ✓ **Staying Connected:** Collaborate with your Project Officer (PO), and, as applicable, your Grants Management Specialist (GMS) to discuss progress and seek support on reporting activities as needed. An active partnership is key to success!
- ✓ **Subrecipient Oversight:** Confirm that your subrecipients, contractors, and partners are compliant with all administrative and policy requirements, including reporting. Note that the Terms and Conditions of the NoA flow down to subrecipients.

## Resources & Support

We are here to help you succeed! To ensure seamless, coordinated support, please copy both your PO and GMS on all correspondence. Direct programmatic questions to your PO, and financial or award administration questions to your GMS.

The primary goal of this guide is to equip you with the knowledge and tools needed to meet your post-award reporting responsibilities efficiently and effectively. Timely and accurate reporting is the principal way we measure progress, promote accountability, and document the incredible work being done. The information you provide is critical for demonstrating the value of the RHT program and informing program funding decisions.

For additional supplemental information and reference materials, please refer to the [Appendix section](#).

After reviewing this guide, you will be able to prepare the following progress reports that meet RHT Program requirements:

1. **Annual Reports, including the Final Report**
2. **Quarterly Reports**

## II. RHT Program Reporting Requirements

While this guide focuses on the successful preparation and submission of Annual and Quarterly Reports, as well as the Final Report, it is important to recognize that these reports are part of a broader landscape of post-award responsibilities. The full scope of federal reporting requirements, as detailed in the [Notice of Funding Opportunity \(NOFO\)](#), includes:

- *Non-Competing Continuation (NCC) Application*
- *Federal Financial Reports (FFR)*
- *Federal Funding Accountability and Transparency Act (FFATA) Reporting*
- *Work Plan Updates*
- *Progress Reports*
- *SAM.gov Records*
- *Payment Management System (PMS) Reports, and*
- *Audit Reporting*

Please refer to the Program Terms and Conditions located within a State's NoA, [NOFO](#), and [CMS website](#) for additional information.

## III. Reporting Cadence & Periods

State awardees are required to submit Annual and Quarterly Progress Reports along with a one-time Final Report. Progress reports must be submitted for all five budget periods (FY26-FY30). These reports are crucial to CMS to make funding decisions for subsequent budget periods.

The first Annual Report, which covers the reporting period from December 29<sup>th</sup>, 2025, to July 31<sup>st</sup>, 2026, is due August 30<sup>th</sup>, 2026. The first quarterly reporting will start in Budget Period 2 of the program. For a comprehensive table of reporting dates, refer to [Appendix A](#).

## IV. Annual, Quarterly, and Final Reports

The following is a breakdown of each progress report that is required throughout the RHT Program.

### Annual Reporting

**The Annual Report** delivers a summary of programmatic progress over the reporting period. Aspects of the **Annual Report** will be scored and used to determine subsequent funding. Within this report, States will report progress on the following:

- **Initiative Progress**
- **Initiative People Served**
- **Initiative Metrics**
- **State Policy Action (SPA) Commitments**
- **Obligated and Spent Funds**
- **Success Stories and Highlights**
- **Sustainability Planning**
- **Definition of Rural Area** (*only Annual Report 1*)

## Quarterly Reporting

**The Quarterly Report** will encompass all activities completed during the specified quarter. The information from these quarterly reports will be used to progressively build and update the Annual Report throughout each budget period. The general reporting periods are as follows: August 1–October 30, October 31–January 30, and January 31–April 30. States should refer to [Appendix A](#) for a comprehensive view of all reporting periods and deadlines. States are required to report progress on the following:

- **Initiative Progress**
- **State Policy Action Commitments**
- **Obligated and Spent Funds**
- **Success Stories and Highlights** (*optional*)

## Final Report

Upon completion of the RHT Program, States are required to submit a one-time only **Final Report**, due February 27<sup>th</sup>, 2031. The Final Report serves to comprehensively document all programmatic activities and initiatives executed throughout the RHT Program's entire period of performance. More information regarding the Final Report will be disseminated closer to the end of the respective reporting period.

# V. Reporting Elements

Across all progress reports, States document their progress across several key areas established by CMS. Although not all reported information is used for scoring, every element is essential for comprehensive oversight and support. Narrative updates and participant metrics help CMS understand exactly how State plans are being put into action. Additionally, Obligated and Spent Funds reporting maintains fiscal transparency, while success stories and sustainability planning highlight real-world outcomes and post-funding momentum. The definition of rural, reported only in Annual report #1, provides transparency into the definition of 'rural area' that the State used to determine whether subrecipients were considered to be rural. Ultimately, these cohesive elements create a

complete picture of operational progress, financial stewardship, and long-term impact within the RHT Program.

**Data elements that determine scoring** will be your initiative checkpoints and progress towards State policy action commitments.

The breakdown below provides further guidance for States to understand the specific requirements for each progress report data element:

- **Initiative Progress Narrative:** Progress updates on milestones and the implementation of initiatives.
- **Initiative People Served:** Provides quantitative context to initiatives and the number of people served.
- **Initiative Metrics:** Quantitative updates on the metrics the State is tracking as part of its approved work plan.
- **Initiative Checkpoints:** Provides context on where States are at with their progress towards the initiative-based score factors.
- **State Policy Actions Commitments:** Progress updates on the State awardee's proposed policy actions as detailed in the approved work plan.
- **Obligated and Spent Funds:** Provides fiscal context on the State's RHT Program expenditures and subrecipients.
- **Success Stories:** Highlights success stories that came out of the State's initiatives that showcase real-world impact of the RHT Program.
- **Sustainability Planning:** Updates on how you plan to sustain successful initiatives after the RHT Program funding ends (after FY31).
- **Definition of Rural:** Provide the definition of 'rural area' that the State used to determine whether subrecipients were considered to be rural (*only Annual Report 1*).

## VI. Completing Your Reports

The following section details the submission procedures for the RHT Program's reporting cycle. The initial Annual Report utilizes an Excel-based template structured around four core components, represented as individual tabs. Comprehensive instructions for completing the Excel template for the initial year are detailed in [Section VII. Getting Started – Submitting your Initial Annual Report](#).

Following the initial report, all subsequent reporting will transition to a web-based system housed within the Medicaid Data Collection Tool (MDCT), referred to as the MDCT RHTP platform. This platform provides States with a centralized workspace to submit updates, upload evidentiary documentation, and communicate with their POs. The first submission utilizing this new system will be the Quarterly Report due on November 29<sup>th</sup>, 2026. Detailed

instructions for navigating and completing reports via the MDCT RHTP platform are outlined in [Section VIII. Subsequent Reporting – MDCT RHTP Platform](#).

## VII. Getting Started – Submitting Your Initial Annual Report

To facilitate a timely and accurate initial Annual Report submission, States should coordinate closely with their Project Officers (POs) to establish an ongoing, rolling review of the report's various components. Because revisions cannot be accommodated after the August 30<sup>th</sup>, 2026 submission deadline, this continuous collaboration is critical to ensure all elements are finalized, reviewed, and approved in a timely manner.

In the initial Annual Report, States will provide the definition of 'rural area' that the State used to determine whether subrecipients were considered to be rural. States will use this same definition to determine rural entities throughout the duration of the RHT Program, so the definition does not need to be included in subsequent reporting.

*For example, in this field, a State may report that they define rural using the following definition from the Health Resources & Services Administration (HRSA):*

- *Non-metropolitan counties*
- *Outlying metropolitan counties with no population from an urban area of 50,000 or more people*
- *Census tracts with Rural-Urban Commuting Area (RUCA) codes 4-10 in metropolitan counties*
- *Census tracts of at least 400 square miles in area with population density of 35 or fewer people per square mile with RUCA codes 2-3 in metropolitan counties*

### Instructions

The Excel Reporting Template is organized into four core sections:

- **Initiative Reporting Section**
  - Checkpoint Guidance Tab
  - Initiative Forms
- **State Policy Actions Form**
- **Obligated and Spent Funds Reporting Section**
  - Entity Type Guidance Tab
  - First-Tier Entities Form
  - Use of Funds Form



- Downstream Obligations Form
- Distribution Reporting
- **Additional Information Form**

**Important Formatting Note: Please do not alter the underlying structure of the Excel Reporting Template**, though you may adjust row heights and column widths for readability. To streamline reporting, CMS will pre-populate certain fields—such as Initiative Name and Initiative Number in the Initiative Forms—based on your approved application. Please note that all forms (tabs) must be fully completed for the report to be considered final.

Alongside the Excel Reporting Template, States should submit all supporting evidentiary documentation directly to their PO for review, via email to accompany the initial Annual Report. This submission should include any files demonstrating progress toward initiative checkpoints and State Policy Action commitments. See [the Submitting Evidentiary Documentation section below for more information](#). **All forms (tabs) must be completed for the submitted report to be considered final.**

The sections below provide additional details for each of the four main components of the Excel Reporting Template.

## 1. Initiative Forms

The purpose of the Initiative Forms is to report on the progress, metrics, and checkpoint completion for each approved State initiative.

In the Excel Reporting Template, there will be a separate Initiative Form (tab) for each initiative.

*Figure 1: Initiative Form (Top)*

| #                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Initiative Name                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Rural Mobile Maternal Health Initiative |
| Narrative                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                         |
| <p>Over the past year, we deployed five fully equipped Mobile Maternity Clinics across 12 of our most underserved counties, effectively eliminating geographic barriers to care. This proactive approach has enabled us to deliver over 2,500 prenatal and postpartum visits directly to expectant mothers, driving a 40% increase in first-trimester care initiation. By integrating satellite-enabled telehealth for high-risk specialist consultations and employing local community health workers to build trust, we have not only expanded essential access but fundamentally transformed the maternal health infrastructure for our rural populations.</p> |                                         |
| Number of People Served                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                         |
| 620                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                         |

Figure 2: Initiative Form (Bottom)

| Number of People Served                    |                                         |               |                               |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------|
| Please provide the number of people served |                                         |               |                               |
| Metrics                                    |                                         |               |                               |
| #                                          | Metric                                  | Current Value | As of Date                    |
| 1                                          | Number of Maternal Care Providers       | 5             | 7/15/2026                     |
| 2                                          |                                         |               |                               |
| 3                                          |                                         |               |                               |
| 4                                          |                                         |               |                               |
| Stage 0 – Planning                         |                                         |               |                               |
| Checkpoint                                 | Yes/No                                  | Attachment(s) |                               |
| 0.1                                        | Establish governance                    | Yes           | StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_0.1a |
| 0.2                                        | Submit project plan to CMS              | Yes           | StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_0.2a |
| Stage 1 – Project Preparation              |                                         |               |                               |
| Checkpoint                                 | Yes/No                                  | Attachment(s) |                               |
| 1.1                                        | CMS approval of project plan            | Yes           | StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_1.1a |
| 1.2                                        | Launch initiative                       | Yes           | StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_1.2a |
| Stage 2 – Early Implementation             |                                         |               |                               |
| Checkpoint                                 | Yes/No                                  | Attachment(s) |                               |
| 2.1                                        | Continue initiative activities          | Yes           | StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_2.1a |
| 2.2                                        | Achieve at least one milestone          | Yes           | StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_2.2a |
| 2.3                                        | Establish metric reporting methodology  | No            |                               |
| 2.4                                        | Submit updated project plan to CMS      | No            |                               |
| Stage 3 – Midway Implementation            |                                         |               |                               |
| Checkpoint                                 | Yes/No                                  | Attachment(s) |                               |
| 3.1                                        | CMS approval of updated project plan    | No            |                               |
| 3.2                                        | Complete Q2 2028 milestones             | No            |                               |
| 3.3                                        | Report initial metric progress to CMS   | No            |                               |
| Stage 4 – Preparation for Completion       |                                         |               |                               |
| Checkpoint                                 | Yes/No                                  | Attachment(s) |                               |
| 4.1                                        | Share final deliverables plan with CMS  | No            |                               |
| 4.2                                        | CMS approval of final deliverables plan | No            |                               |
| 4.3                                        | Complete post-program planning          | No            |                               |
| Stage 5 – Full Implementation              |                                         |               |                               |
| Checkpoint                                 | Yes/No                                  | Attachment(s) |                               |
| 5.1                                        | Submit final deliverables to CMS        | No            |                               |
| 5.2                                        | Complete all 2030 milestones            | No            |                               |
| 5.3                                        | Report updated metric progress to CMS   | No            |                               |

Figure 2 above shows a draft Initiative Form completed with a hypothetical example to illustrate the required information.

Figure 3 below includes the relevant data fields in the Initiative Form, instructions for how to fill out each data field, and an example data value for each field. **Please note, the examples below are notional and should only be used as a guide.**

Figure 3: Initiative Form Instructions

| Data Field        | Instructions                                                             | Example                                        |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Initiative Number | This field will be <b>pre-populated</b> in the Excel Reporting Template. | 1                                              |
| Initiative Name   | This field will be <b>pre-populated</b> in the Excel Reporting Template. | Rural Maternal Mobile Health Clinic Initiative |

|                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Narrative</b></p>               | <p>Provide a concise update on the progress of each initiative during the reporting period. Responses should focus on key activities completed, milestones reached, challenges encountered, and any notable outcomes or impacts to date.</p> <p>This section is intended for progress reporting purposes only and should not repeat the full project narrative from the NCC Kit. Please focus on recent initiative progress and avoid including broad background information unless it is necessary for context.</p> <p>States are encouraged to include any relevant updates that may be important for CMS to understand the status, implementation progress, or emerging results of the initiative.</p> <p>Note: The Narrative is optional for quarterly reporting.</p> <p><b>Please limit responses to 2,000 characters, or approximately 250–350 words.</b></p> <p><i>Over the past year, we deployed five fully equipped Mobile Maternity Clinics across 12 of our most underserved counties, effectively eliminating geographic barriers to care. This proactive approach has enabled us to deliver over 2,500 prenatal and postpartum visits directly to expectant mothers, driving a 40% increase in first-trimester care initiation. By integrating satellite-enabled telehealth for high-risk specialist consultations and employing local community health workers to build trust, we have not only expanded essential access but fundamentally transformed the maternal health infrastructure for our rural populations.</i></p> |
| <p><b>Number of People Served</b></p> | <p>Provide your best estimate of the number of individuals who have benefited from RHT Program funds during the reporting period. Estimates should be reasonable, supported by available data, and reflect the scope and reach of the initiative. For system-based initiatives that do not provide direct services (e.g., IT systems, Health Information Exchanges), States</p> <p>620</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                             | <p>may define the number of people served more broadly.</p> <p>For example:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ For health system–level initiatives, the number served may reflect the total population served by the system.</li> <li>▪ For statewide systems (e.g., HIEs), the number served may reflect the number of patients with data in the system or the total number of state residents.</li> <li>▪ These estimates do not need to be de-duplicated and do not need to be limited to rural populations if the initiative has a broader reach.</li> <li>▪ States should aim to provide the most accurate and justifiable estimate possible and may include brief context in the narrative section if helpful for CMS’s understanding.</li> </ul> <p><b>Note: Number of People Served is only reported annually.</b></p> |
| <b>Metrics</b>              | <p>The metrics for each initiative will be <b>pre-populated</b> based on the information provided in your application and clarified in your Initiative Information Report.</p> <p><b>Note: Metrics are only reported annually.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Metric Current Value</b> | <p>The latest value for the corresponding metric.</p> <p>5</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

|                          |                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Metric As of Date</b> | The date that the current value was measured in the following format: (XX/XX/XXXX).                                                  | 03/15/2026                                                                                      |
| <b>Checkpoints</b>       | For each stage, the checkpoint number and description are <b>pre-populated</b> .                                                     | 0.1 Establish Governance                                                                        |
| <b>Yes/No</b>            | Select “Yes” if the checkpoint is complete; Select “No” if the checkpoint is not yet complete.                                       | Yes                                                                                             |
| <b>Attachment(s)</b>     | Paste in the attachment file names of the evidentiary documentation files that correspond to the relevant initiative and checkpoint. | StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_2.2a<br>StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_2.2b<br>StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_2.2c |

| Score Factor | Workload Funding Score Factor Criterion | Baseline                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Commitment                                                                                                                                                    | Current Status                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Supporting Evidence                                                                                                                          | Optional Comments/Notes |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| B.2.         | Presidential Fitness Test               | 0 Points: A State does not require schools to reestablish the Presidential Fitness Test                                                                                                                               | 100 Points: A State requires schools to reestablish the Presidential Fitness Test that is aligned with federal guidance associated with Executive Order 14327 | 0 Points: A State does not require schools to reestablish the Presidential Fitness Test                                                                                                                               | StateX_SPA_B.2                                                                                                                               |                         |
| B.3.         | SNAP Food Restriction Waiver Policy     | 0 Points: State has no pending or approved USDA SNAP food restriction waiver prohibiting the purchase of non-nutritious items or no pending State bill requiring a food restriction waiver be submitted to USDA       | 100 Points: USDA approved State waiver prohibiting the purchase of non-nutritious items in SNAP                                                               | 75 Points: State submitted a waiver prohibiting the purchase of non-nutritious items in SNAP and waiver is in processing with USDA                                                                                    | SNAP Food Waiver Legislation: <a href="http://www.legislature.state.X.gov/bills/2026/HB125">www.legislature.state.X.gov/bills/2026/HB125</a> |                         |
| B.4.         | Nutrition Continuing Medical Education  | 0 Points: States that have no requirement for nutrition to be included in continuing medical education (CME) for physicians as well as no pending State bill requiring nutrition to be included in CME for physicians | 100 Points: Requirement for nutrition to be included in CME for physicians is currently in place and enforced                                                 | 0 Points: States that have no requirement for nutrition to be included in continuing medical education (CME) for physicians as well as no pending State bill requiring nutrition to be included in CME for physicians | StateX_SPA_B.4                                                                                                                               |                         |

## 2. State Policy Actions Form

|      |                                 |                                                                                                        |                                                                                           |                                                                                                        |                                               |  |
|------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--|
| C.3. | Overall CON Score               | 50 Points: 45-79 score from the Cicero report for States with moderate CONs across facility categories | 100 Points: 0 score from Cicero report for States with no CONs across facility categories | 50 Points: 45-79 score from the Cicero report for States with moderate CONs across facility categories | www.legislature.state.ND.gov/bills/2026/HB102 |  |
|      | CON - Behavioral Outpatient     | Restricted                                                                                             | Commitment Made                                                                           | Restricted                                                                                             |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Medical Outpatient        | Restricted                                                                                             | Commitment Made                                                                           | Restricted                                                                                             |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Behavioral Inpatient      | Unrestricted                                                                                           | No Commitment                                                                             |                                                                                                        |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Imaging                   | Unrestricted                                                                                           | No Commitment                                                                             |                                                                                                        |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Medical Inpatient         | Restricted                                                                                             | Commitment Made                                                                           | Restricted                                                                                             |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Day Services              | Restricted                                                                                             | Commitment Made                                                                           | Restricted                                                                                             |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Long-term Care Facilities | Restricted                                                                                             | Commitment Made                                                                           | Restricted                                                                                             |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Ancillaries               | Restricted                                                                                             | Commitment Made                                                                           | Restricted                                                                                             |                                               |  |
|      | CON - Other                     | Restricted                                                                                             | Commitment Made                                                                           | Restricted                                                                                             |                                               |  |

The State Policy Actions (SPA) Form is designed to capture the progress and status of the specific policy commitments established in a State's approved application. Please note that States are only eligible to receive credit for policy actions committed to in their initial application.

Figure 4 above shows a draft State Policy Action Commitments Form completed with a hypothetical example to illustrate the required information. **Please note, there are additional fields in a section titled “CMS Review (CMS Use Only)” in the State Policy Actions Form (not pictured in Figure 5 below), which should not be populated by States.**

Figure 5 below outlines the data fields within the State Policy Action (SPA) Form, along with specific instructions for completing each field and illustrative examples. **Note: These examples are strictly notional and are provided solely for guidance.**

Figure 5: State Policy Actions Form Instructions

| Data Field                                     | Instructions                                                                                           | Example                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Score Factor</b>                            | This data field is <b>pre-populated</b> with the relevant score factor labels.                         | <i>B.2.</i>                                                                                                   |
| <b>Workload Funding Score Factor Criterion</b> | This data field is <b>pre-populated</b> with the relevant score factor criterion.                      | <i>Presidential Fitness Test</i>                                                                              |
| <b>Baseline</b>                                | This data field is <b>pre-populated</b> with a baseline value for each State policy action commitment. | <i>The baseline values are unique to each State policy action and will be consistent with the State's SPA</i> |

|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                | The baseline refers to the category of the baseline score for the State policy action score factor.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <i>commitment report. Examples include:</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• No points (0)</li> <li>• Partial points (1–99)</li> <li>• Full points (100)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Commitment</b>              | This data field is <b>pre-populated</b> , and the value depends on if the relevant State policy action commitment was made and approved by CMS.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <i>If a State policy action commitment was made in the application:</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Partial Points (1-99)</li> <li>• Full points (100)</li> <li>• Commitment Made</li> </ul><br><i>If State policy action commitment was not made in application:</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• No Commitment</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Current Status</b>          | Select the current status from the dropdown menu (options reflect the scoring methodology in the NOFO and are dependent on the specific State policy action commitment). If the State policy action commitment was made, the Current Status cell for that Score Factor will appear white and the status can be indicated with the dropdown. If a State policy action commitment was not made, the cell will be greyed out. | <i>For State policy action commitment B.3. (for example) dropdown options include:</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Not Yet Started</li> <li>• 0 Points: No pending State legislation</li> <li>• 25 Points: Active bill in the State legislative process</li> <li>• 50 Points: State bill was passed to submit a USDA waiver</li> <li>• 75 Points: Waiver is in processing with USDA</li> <li>• 100 Points: USDA approved waiver</li> <li>• Commitment abandoned</li> </ul><br><i>Note: Specific options will depend on each Score Factor.</i> |
| <b>Supporting Evidence</b>     | Provide any links to sources or attachments that confirm the status of the State policy action commitment.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <i>Examples may include:</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• URL to policy on State website</li> <li>• State legislation attachment</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Optional Notes/Comments</b> | Provide any additional context or details around the status of the State policy action commitment, if needed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <i>The bill, titled “XYZ” was signed into law on July 15, 2026, and becomes effective January 1, 2027.</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

### 3. Obligated and Spent Funds Reporting Tabs

The purpose of the Obligated and Spent Funds Reporting tabs is to track RHT Program spending across initiatives, budget period awards, use of funds categories, subrecipients, and contractors. Please refer to the **Obligated and Spent Funds Reporting Guide** for more information on how to populate the First-Tier Entities, Use of Funds, Downstream Obligations, and Distribution Reporting tabs.

### 4. Additional Information Form

The purpose of the Additional Information Form is to share qualitative updates on program successes, long-term sustainability planning, and the definition of rural, as defined by the State.

*Figure 6: Success Stories*

| Success Stories                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>Please share success stories that you want to highlight as result of your State's implementation of the RHT Program.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p>In a rural county, a community with no local obstetrician, our new mobile health clinic (Initiative 1) provided prenatal care to 45 expectant mothers. One patient was able to receive all her prenatal checkups locally, avoiding a 3-hour round trip to the nearest city. This consistent care led to the early detection of a complication, ensuring a healthy delivery for both mother and baby.</p> |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>Based on the high demand for the mobile clinic, we have initiated discussions with the State Medicaid agency to establish a permanent reimbursement pathway for mobile health services. Furthermore, we have secured a partnership with the State University's nursing school to create a clinical rotation program on the mobile unit, which will provide a sustainable staffing pipeline and reduce future personnel costs.</p> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|



Figure 8: Rural Definition

| Rural Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Please provide the definition of 'rural area' that the State used to determine whether subrecipients were considered to be rural.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <p>We defined rural using the following definition from the Health Resources &amp; Services Administration (HRSA). They defined the following area as rural:</p> <p>Non-metropolitan counties</p> <p>Outlying metropolitan counties with no population from an urban area of 50,000 or more people</p> <p>Census tracts with Rural-Urban Commuting Area (RUCA) codes 4-10 in metropolitan counties</p> <p>Census tracts of at least 400 square miles in area with population density of 35 or fewer people per square mile with RUCA codes 2-3 in metropolitan counties</p> |

The figures above show the Additional Information Form completed with a hypothetical example to illustrate the required information.

Figure 9 below outlines the data fields within the Additional Information Form, along with specific instructions for completing each field and illustrative examples. **Note: These examples are strictly notional and are provided solely for guidance.**

Figure 9: Additional Information Form Instructions

| Data Field                     | Instructions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Example                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Success Stories</b>         | <p>Provide narrative example(s) of how the RHT Program has positively impacted rural communities in your State. Focus on specific, compelling stories that demonstrate the program's value.</p> <p><b>Please limit responses to 3,000 characters, approximately 400–500 words.</b></p> | <p><i>In a [rural county] with no local obstetrician, our new mobile health clinic (Initiative 1) provided prenatal care to 45 expectant mothers. One patient was able to receive all her prenatal checkups locally, avoiding a 3-hour round trip to the nearest city. This consistent care led to the early detection of a complication, ensuring a healthy delivery for both mother and baby.</i></p> |
| <b>Sustainability Planning</b> | <p>Describe significant updates to your State's plan for continuing the program's impact after the</p>                                                                                                                                                                                 | <p><i>Based on the high demand for a mobile clinic, we have initiated discussions with the State Medicaid</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

|                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                   | <p>grant period ends. This should be based on your experiences, successes, and challenges from the past year.</p> <p><b>Please limit responses to 3,000 characters, approximately 400–500 words.</b></p> | <p><i>agency to establish a permanent reimbursement pathway for mobile health services. Furthermore, we have secured a partnership with the State University's nursing school to create a clinical rotation program on the mobile unit, which will provide a sustainable staffing pipeline and reduce future personnel costs.</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <p><b>Definition of Rural</b></p> | <p>Please provide the rural definition the State used to determine whether subrecipients were considered to be rural.</p>                                                                                | <p><i>We defined rural using the following definition from the Health Resources &amp; Services Administration (HRSA). They define the following areas as rural:</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><i>• Non-metropolitan counties</i></li> <li><i>• Outlying metropolitan counties with no population from an urban area of 50,000 or more people</i></li> <li><i>• Census tracts with Rural-Urban Commuting Area (RUCA) codes 4-10 in metropolitan counties</i></li> <li><i>• Census tracts of at least 400 square miles in area with population density of 35 or fewer people per square mile with RUCA codes 2-3 in metropolitan counties</i></li> </ul> |

## 5. Submitting Evidentiary Documentation

For the initial Annual Report, States will submit all evidentiary documentation to their PO for review, via email. To allow ample time for review and feedback, States are strongly encouraged to provide documentation to their POs on a rolling basis prior to the final submission deadline.

Evidentiary documentation is only required for the following two components:

- Initiative Checkpoints:** Documentation requirements vary depending on the specific checkpoint. States should provide evidence that directly corresponds to and demonstrates completion or progress for each individual checkpoint. Refer to the **Checkpoint Guidance tab** in the Excel Reporting Template for examples of acceptable evidence.

- **State Policy Actions (SPAs) Form:** For each SPA for which there is an update in the Current Status, States must provide evidentiary documentation or a direct URL (e.g., a link to legislation, regulation, or a state register) that demonstrates progress toward the policy commitment. States may include a hyperlink directly within the Excel Reporting Template or submit a corresponding file.

In order to assist your PO in understanding which pieces of evidentiary documentation apply to each checkpoint or State policy action, consider the following file name guidelines:

- The file name of each piece of evidentiary documentation should be clearly labeled with the Initiative Name, Number, and Checkpoint or SPA that it corresponds to for ease of review (e.g., “StateX\_Init\_2\_Checkpoint\_0.1.pdf” or “StateX\_SPA\_B.2.pdf”).
- If multiple pieces of evidentiary documentation apply to the same initiative, States should indicate this using a, b, c, etc. at the end of the file name (e.g., “StateX\_Init\_2\_Checkpoint\_0.1a.pdf” and “StateX\_Init\_2\_Checkpoint\_0.1b.docx”).
- If one piece of evidentiary documentation applies to the same checkpoint across multiple initiatives, list the initiatives or provide a number range in the file name (e.g., “StateX\_Init\_1\_2\_Checkpoint\_0.1.pdf” or “StateX\_Init\_2-7\_Checkpoint\_0.1.pdf”).

## 6. Submitting Your Initial Annual Report

For the initial Annual Report, States must:

- Complete the Excel Reporting Template.
- Submit all associated evidentiary documentation for all checkpoint and SPA commitment progress for the reporting period.

Prior to the submission deadline, States will compile and upload all respective materials into GrantSolutions for official recordkeeping. For this final submission to GrantSolutions, you should:

- Note that some evidentiary files will need to be converted to PDF format prior to uploading.
- Keep the exact same base file name used in your original files (e.g., if you sent the native file StateX\_Init\_1\_Checkpoint\_0.2.xlsx to your PO, upload the converted version to GrantSolutions as StateX\_Init\_1\_Checkpoint\_0.2.pdf).

## VIII. Subsequent Reporting - MDCT RHTP Platform

Following the initial Annual Report submission via the Excel Reporting Template, the RHT Program will transition subsequent reporting to the MDCT RHTP platform, beginning with the first Quarterly Report. To ensure a seamless transition, comprehensive training and technical assistance will be provided to support States in adopting the new platform.

For continuity and ease of use, data submitted from the initial Annual Report will be pre-populated within MDCT RHTP, serving as a convenient baseline reference for all future reporting.

States should continue to collaborate closely with their POs to review and finalize report components within the platform. Please note that after submission, States will not be able to access their report for revision.

For any technical questions regarding access, functionality, or system issues with the MDCT RHTP application, please reach out to the MDCT Help Desk at [MDCT\\_help@cms.hhs.gov](mailto:MDCT_help@cms.hhs.gov). The help desk hours are 9am – 5pm ET, Monday-Friday (excluding holidays).

The guidance below details the procedures for submitting both Annual and Quarterly Reports via the MDCT RHTP platform. Throughout subsequent reporting cycles, States should continue to leverage the Checkpoint Guidance and other supporting materials to complete their submissions.

### Instructions

The platform's reporting interface consists of seven pages where States will input their progress data. Each page includes instructions for completion. The seven pages in the MDCT RHTP platform are:

- 1. General Information**
- 2. Initiative Attachments**
- 3. Initiatives**
- 4. State Policy Commitments**
- 5. Use of Funds**
- 6. Sustainability and Highlights**
- 7. Review & Submit**

## 1. General Information

In this page, States will be required to provide information regarding key personnel that can be contacted for any inquiries related to the report.

Figure 10: General Information

{State: Name of the report submission}

✓ Last saved XX:XXpm

<

{Name of the report}

General Information

Initiative Attachments

Initiatives

State Policy Commitments

Use of Funds

Sustainability and Highlights

Review & Submit

### General Information

**Authorized Organizational Representative (AOR)**  
Enter the name for CMS to contact with questions about this report.

**Authorized Organizational Representative (AOR) Contact email**  
Enter the email address for the AOR.

**Principal Investigator or Program Director**  
Enter the name for CMS to contact with questions about this report.

**Principal Investigator or Program Director Contact email**  
Enter the email address for the PI/PD.

**Point of Contact (POC) listed in NoA (Optional)**  
Optionally added and approved by CMS

**Point of Contact (POC) email (Optional)**  
Enter the email address for the Additional Point of Contact listed in the NoA

Continue >

Figure 11 below includes the relevant data fields on the General Information page. Instructions for how to fill out each data field, and an example data value, if needed, for each field. If there is a 3<sup>rd</sup> point of contact (additional Point of Contact as authorized in the NoA), please list them below. **Please note, the examples are notional and should only be used as a guide.**

Figure 11: General Information Instructions

| Data Field                                                          | Instructions                                                                                 | Example                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>Authorized Organizational Representative (AOR)</b>               | Enter person's name or a position title for CMS to contact with questions about this report. | <i>Jane Smith</i>             |
| <b>Authorized Organizational Representative (AOR) Contact email</b> | A department or program-wide email address is acceptable.                                    | <i>JaneSmith@state.gov</i>    |
| <b>Principle Investigator or Program Director</b>                   | Enter person's name or a position title for CMS to contact with questions about this report. | <i>John Williams</i>          |
| <b>Principle Investigator or Program Director Contact email</b>     | A department or program-wide email address is acceptable.                                    | <i>JohnWilliams@state.gov</i> |

## 2. Initiative Attachments

States may add, edit, or delete existing attachments (depending on their status), and add or respond to comments from their POs associated with specific attachments.

Attachments that apply across multiple initiatives should be uploaded on this page, while initiative-specific attachments should be uploaded within the Initiatives page. Both informational attachments and attachments intended for rescoring may be submitted on this page.

This page also includes an Understanding Initiative Statuses section, which provides guidance on the various initiative statuses that may be encountered, including:

- **Pending Review:** This status is applied automatically when a new attachment is added. It lets CMS know the document is ready to be reviewed.

- **Needs Revision:** CMS uses this status when a document needs updates or corrections from the State. Please review CMS feedback and upload a revised version as needed.
- **Locked for Scoring:** CMS uses this status when a document has been locked for scoring.
- **Informational:** CMS or the State may use this status for documents that are for reference only. These documents are not used for scoring.
- **Archived:** CMS or the State may use this status for documents that are no longer part of the active submission but should be kept for records. Archived documents will not carry over from one report to the next.

Figure 12: Attachments

{Name of the report}

General Information

Initiative Attachments

Initiatives

State Policy Commitments

Use of Funds

Sustainability and Highlights

Review & Submit

## Initiative Attachments

The table below lists all attachments added to any initiatives. From here you can:

- Add new attachments
- Edit or delete existing attachments dependent on their status
- Leave or respond to comments on any attachment
- Utilize the comment icon to add new comments and adjust statuses where appropriate by attachment

Understanding initiative statuses

- **Pending Review** - This status is applied automatically when a new attachment is added. It lets CMS know the document is ready to be reviewed.
- **Needs Revision** - CMS uses this status when a document needs updates or corrections from the state. Please review CMS feedback and upload a revised version as needed. When in this status, attachments can no longer be deleted.
- **Locked for Scoring** - CMS uses this status when a document has been locked for scoring. When in this status, attachments are locked and cannot be edited or deleted.
- **Informational** - CMS or the state may use this status for documents that are for reference only. These documents are not used for scoring. When in this status, attachments can no longer be deleted.
- **Archived** - CMS or the state may use this status for documents that are no longer part of the active submission but should be kept for records. When in this status, attachments can no longer be deleted.

+ Add Attachment

| Name              | Initiatives              | Stage/<br>Checkpoint   | Last Edited | Status       | Actions                                    |
|-------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|-------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------|
| {Attachment name} | {Initiatives #1, #2, #3} | {Stage/<br>checkpoint} | 04/15/2026  | Needs review | <div>Edit</div> <div>Status/Comments</div> |
| {Attachment name} | {Initiatives #1, #2, #3} | {Stage/<br>checkpoint} | 04/15/2026  | Needs review | <div>Edit</div> <div>Status/Comments</div> |
| {Attachment name} | {Initiatives #1, #2, #3} | {Stage/<br>checkpoint} | 04/15/2026  | Needs review | <div>Edit</div> <div>Status/Comments</div> |

Previous

Continue

As shown above, the interface allows users to manage their uploaded attachments (via commenting, editing, or deleting) and upload new files as needed.

Figure 13 below includes the relevant data fields in the Initiative Attachments page, instructions for how to fill out each data field, and an example data value, if needed, for each field. **Please note, the examples are notional and should only be used as a guide.**

Figure 13: Initiative Attachment Instructions

| Data Field              | Instructions                                                                             | Example                             |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Add Attachment</b>   | Click on the icon to add attachments                                                     |                                     |
| <b>Attachment name</b>  | Name of attachment will be populated based on the naming of the file being uploaded      | <i>StateX_Init_1_Checkpoint_0.1</i> |
| <b>Initiatives</b>      | The screen will prompt States to check off which Initiatives the attachment applies to   | <i>1,3,5</i>                        |
| <b>Stage/Checkpoint</b> | The screen will prompt States to select which Stage/Checkpoint the attachment applies to | <i>0.1 Establish Governance</i>     |

## Relevant Initiative Actions

Below are guidelines for common questions that States may ask while viewing and uploading information to the Initiative Attachments page.

### 1. Uploading an attachment

To upload documentation, click the **+ Add Attachment** icon located below the ‘Understanding Initiative Statuses’ section. A pop-up window will display checkboxes to designate which initiatives the file applies to. Below these checkboxes, use the dropdown menu to select the corresponding stage or checkpoint. Finally, drag files directly into the window or select them from a folder to complete the upload.



Figure 16: Add Comments to Attachments

### Add comment to attachment ✕ Close

Use the fields below to manage the attachment status and leave comments for your CMS Project Officer. Certain statuses restrict the ability to modify or remove files:

- Needs Revision, Informational, Archived:** The attachment will no longer be able to be deleted.
- Locked for Scoring:** The attachment is locked and cannot be edited or deleted.

**Attachment:** {Name of attachment}

**Status**

**Comment**

[Add comment](#)

[Close](#)

Figure 15: Add Attachments

[+ Add Attachment](#)

| Name              | Initiatives              | Stage/<br>Checkpoint   | Last Edited | Status       | Actions                                              |
|-------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|-------------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| {Attachment name} | {Initiatives #1, #2, #3} | {Stage/<br>checkpoint} | 04/15/2026  | Needs review | <a href="#">Edit</a> <a href="#">Status/Comments</a> |
| {Attachment name} | {Initiatives #1, #2, #3} | {Stage/<br>checkpoint} | 04/15/2026  | Needs review | <a href="#">Edit</a> <a href="#">Status/Comments</a> |
| {Attachment name} | {Initiatives #1, #2, #3} | {Stage/<br>checkpoint} | 04/15/2026  | Needs review | <a href="#">Edit</a> <a href="#">Status/Comments</a> |

Figure 14: Upload Initiative Attachments

### Upload Initiative Attachments ✕ Close

**Which initiative does this attachment apply to?**

☐ {Initiative 1}  
☐ {Initiative 2}  
☐ {Initiative 3}  
☐ {Initiative 4}  
☐ {Initiative 5}

**Which stage/checkpoint does this attachment apply to?**

**Select a file or files to upload**

Drag files here or [Choose from folder](#)

**Selected Files**

file.ext  
 7 KB  


file.ext  
Incorrect file format - cannot be uploaded  
 10 KB

**Uploaded Files**

These files have been attached to the stage(s) and checkpoint(s) selected above.

file2.ext  
 10 KB

[Done](#)

## 2. Adding a comment to an attachment

To leave a note for a Project Officer (PO)/ CMS, use the commenting feature within the MDCT RHTP platform. On the Initiative Attachments dashboard, click the **“Status/comment”** button next to the relevant attachment to add a message.

## 3. Editing attachments

If there are changes to attachment files or to the initiative(s) or checkpoint(s) the attachment applies to, you may update their selections. In the Actions column, select the **“Edit”** button. A pop-up window will appear displaying a list of initiatives with checkboxes. States can select or deselect the initiatives to indicate where the attachment applies.

*Figure 17: Editing Attachments*

**Edit Attachment**
✕ Close

**Which initiative does this attachment apply to?**

☒ {Initiative 1}
 ☐ {Initiative 2}
 ☐ {Initiative 3}
 ☐ {Initiative 4}
 ☐ {Initiative 5}

**Which stage/checkpoint does this attachment apply to?**

0.1 Establish governance
 ▼

**File**

This file is attached to the stage and checkpoint selected above.

file2.ext

10 KB

Save

#### 4. Viewing an attachment's comments

In the Actions column, click the **"Status/comment"** button. A pop-up window will appear, allowing States to view a historical log of comments associated with the selected attachment. This log includes all comments provided by their PO on the uploaded attachment. States are also allowed to **"Delete"** erroneous attachment as long as it is in **"Pending Review"** mode and has no comments. If there have been any additional actions taken on the attachment, it cannot be deleted and should be moved to **"Archived"**.

*Figure 18: Viewing Attachment Comments*

**Comments**

**{Name}** {Date} {Time}

Status:

Shared with State

Ready for review

**{Name}** {Date} {Time}

Status:

Shared with State

Ready for review

---

Close

### 3. Initiatives

Figure 19: Initiatives

<

{Name of the report}

General Information

Initiative Attachments

Initiatives

State Policy Commitments

Use of Funds

Sustainability and Highlights

Review & Submit

## Initiatives

The list below includes initiatives you have previously submitted to CMS. Select **Edit** for each initiative to report on its progress.

| Initiative                                          | Actions              |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| {Initiative number and name}<br>Status: Not started | <a href="#">Edit</a> |
| {Initiative number and name}<br>Status: Not started | <a href="#">Edit</a> |
| {Initiative number and name}<br>Status: Not started | <a href="#">Edit</a> |
| {Initiative number and name}<br>Status: Not started | <a href="#">Edit</a> |

[< Previous](#)
[Continue >](#)

This page will be pre-populated with each Initiative's number and name. Select the **"Edit"** button for each Initiative to begin reporting.

Figure 20 below displays the Initiative reporting page, including fields for entering a narrative summary, reporting metrics, and managing checkpoint status and attachments.

Figure 20: Initiative Number/Name

## {Initiative number and name}

Use this page to provide information about your initiative and the metrics you use to measure its progress. Then, update any checkpoints for review.

What is included in Annual Reporting vs Quarterly Reporting?

### Annual Reporting Data should include:

- Initiative Progress Narrative
- Initiative People Served
- Initiative Metrics
- Initiative Checkpoints

### Quarterly Reporting Data can include:

- Initiative Progress Narrative (Optional)
- Initiative Checkpoints

### Narrative (Required Annually)

Narrative is optional for quarterly reporting. Limit responses to 2,000 characters, or approximately 250–350 words.

[Initiative Progress Narrative Guidance](#)

XXX characters allowed

### Number of people served

Number of People Served is only reported annually.

[Reporting Guidelines](#)

Figure 21: Metrics

## Metrics

The metrics for each initiative will be **pre-populated** based on the information previously provided. Metrics are only reported annually. Contact your Project Officer if the metrics listed are incorrect. Note: Metrics are only reported annually.

| # | Status    | Metric                                                                | Target | Previous Value       | Current Value        | As of Date<br>MM/DD/YYYY |
|---|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|
| 1 | Active    | Rural provider retention rate                                         | 90%    | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>     |
| 2 | Active    | Percent of rural facilities utilizing RPM                             | 90%    | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>     |
| 3 | Active    | Percent of rural facilities utilizing AI-assisted documentation tools | 90%    | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>     |
| 4 | Active    | Number of rural providers with loan repayment                         | 100    | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>     |
| 5 | Abandoned | Number of counties classified as HPSA                                 | 150    | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>     |

## Checkpoints

Checkpoints are grouped into the stages listed below. On this page, you can take the following actions on any checkpoint unless otherwise noted.

- Add or remove attachments of evidentiary documentation.
- Select the checkbox when the checkpoint is complete and ready for CMS review.
- Leave comments for CMS, or respond to comments from them by attachment.

Figure 22: Checkpoint Stages

#### Stage 0: Planning

[+ Upload attachments](#)

| #   | Checkpoint                 | Ready for CMS Review                | Attachments                | Status         | Actions                                                             |
|-----|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0.1 | Establish governance       | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | <a href="#">file1.docx</a> | Pending review | <a href="#">Edit</a> <a href="#">Messages</a> <a href="#">Close</a> |
|     |                            |                                     | <a href="#">file2.docx</a> | Pending review | <a href="#">Edit</a> <a href="#">Messages</a> <a href="#">Close</a> |
| 0.2 | Submit project plan to CMS | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Not applicable             |                |                                                                     |

#### Stage 1: Project Preparation

[+ Upload attachments](#)

| #   | Checkpoint                   | Ready for CMS Review     | Attachments    | Status | Actions |
|-----|------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------|--------|---------|
| 1.1 | CMS approval of project plan | <input type="checkbox"/> | Not applicable |        |         |
| 1.2 | Launch initiative            | <input type="checkbox"/> |                |        |         |

Figure 23 below includes the relevant data fields in the Initiative section, instructions for how to fill out each data field, and an example data value, if needed, for each field. **Please note, the examples are notional and should only be used as a guide.**

Figure 23: Initiative Progress Instructions

| Data Field       | Instructions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Example                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Narrative</b> | <p>Provide a concise update on the progress of each initiative during the reporting period. Responses should focus on key activities completed, milestones reached, challenges encountered, and any notable outcomes or impacts to date.</p> <p>This section is intended for progress reporting purposes only and should not repeat the full project narrative from the NCC Kit. Please focus on recent initiative progress and avoid including broad</p> | <p>Over the past year, we deployed five fully equipped Mobile Maternity Clinics across 12 of our most underserved counties, effectively eliminating geographic barriers to care. This proactive approach has enabled us to deliver over 2,500 prenatal and postpartum visits directly to expectant mothers, driving a 40% increase in first-trimester care initiation. By integrating satellite-enabled telehealth for high-risk specialist consultations and</p> |

|                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                       | <p>background information unless it is necessary for context.</p> <p>States are encouraged to include any relevant updates that may be important for CMS to understand the status, implementation progress, or emerging results of the initiative.</p> <p><b>Note: The Narrative is optional for quarterly reporting.</b></p> <p><b>Please limit responses to 2,000 characters, or approximately 250–350 words.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <p><i>employing local community health workers to build trust, we have not only expanded essential access but fundamentally transformed the maternal health infrastructure for our rural populations.</i></p> |
| <p><b>Number of People Served</b></p> | <p>Provide best estimate of the number of individuals who have benefited from RHT Program funds during the reporting period. Estimates should be reasonable, supported by available data, and reflect the scope and reach of the initiative. For system-based initiatives that do not provide direct services (e.g., IT systems, Health Information Exchanges), States may define the number of people served more broadly.</p> <p>For example:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ For health system–level initiatives, the number served may reflect the total population served by the system.</li> <li>▪ For statewide systems (e.g., HIEs), the number served may reflect the number of patients with data in the system or the total number of state residents.</li> <li>▪ These estimates do not need to be de-duplicated and do not need to be limited to rural populations if the initiative has a broader reach.</li> <li>▪ States should aim to provide the most accurate and justifiable estimate possible and may include brief context</li> </ul> | <p>500</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

in the narrative section if helpful for CMS's understanding.

**Note: Number of People Served is only reported annually.**

|                         |                                                                                                                                                        |        |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| <b>Metric</b>           | The metric for each initiative will be pre-populated based on the information previously provided.                                                     | 20     |
|                         | <b>Note: Metrics are only reported annually.</b>                                                                                                       |        |
| <b>Metric Status</b>    | Metric status will be displayed with the following potential statuses: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Active</li> <li>• Abandoned</li> </ul> | Active |
| <b>Target Value (%)</b> | Target values will be pre-populated and will be updated based on States' information. The field will not be able to be edited.                         | 90     |



|                                       |                                                                                                                      |            |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <b>Previous Value</b>                 | Previous values that States have reported will be displayed. The field will not be able to be edited.                | 5          |
| <b>Metric Current Value</b>           | Enter the current value of each metric relevant to the reporting period.                                             | 3          |
| <b>Metric as of Date (MM/DD/YYYY)</b> | Enter the as of date of the metric.                                                                                  | 04/19/2026 |
| <b>Checkpoint Attachments Upload</b>  | Add or remove documentation attachments and leave comments or respond to comments for each checkpoint attachment.    |            |
| <b>Ready for CMS Review</b>           | Check the box once a checkpoint is ready for CMS Review. Leave unchecked if the checkpoint requires further editing. |            |

## 4. State Policy Commitments

On this page, the SPA Form displays a list of policy commitments approved by CMS, as outlined in the State's approved application. Each commitment can be expanded to update its status, evidence, and comments for the current reporting period.

For each commitment, only legislation links and attachments are accepted as valid evidence demonstrating progress toward fulfillment of the policy commitment. Press releases and promotional links or attachments will not be accepted as sufficient evidence.

Figure 24: State Policy Commitments

{Name of the report}

General Information

Initiative Attachments

Initiatives

State Policy Commitments

Use of Funds

Sustainability and Highlights

Review & Submit

### State Policy Commitments

The commitments listed here are based on those identified in a State's approved application. Expand each one to update its status, evidence, and comments.

[Expand all](#)
[Collapse all](#)

B.2: Presidential Fitness Test

+

B.3: SNAP Food Restriction Waiver Policy

—

Current status

- Select an option -

▼

Supporting Evidence

States should only submit legislation links and attachments as acceptable evidence for their State policy commitments. CMS will not accept press releases or promotional links/attachments as substantial evidence.

Links

Add URL to exact policy.

+

Add link

Attachments

Upload state legislation.

+

Upload attachment

Notes and comments (optional)

Include any additional information about this policy commitment that you would like CMS to be aware of.

B.4: Nutrition Continuing Medical Education

+

C.3: Overall CON Score

+

D.2: Physician Assistant - PA Compact

+

D.3: Dental Hygienist - Prescriptive Authority

+

◀ Previous

Continue ▶

Figure 25 below outlines the relevant data fields on the State Policy Commitments page, along with instructions for completing each field and illustrative example values, where applicable. **Please note, the examples are notional and should only be used as a guide.**

Figure 25: State Policy Commitment Page Instructions

| Data Field                              | Instructions                                                                                                  | Example                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Current Status</b>                   | Select from the drop down the corresponding status for each commitment during the reporting period            |                                                                                              |
| <b>Supporting Evidence: Links</b>       | Provide link(s) to State legislation that confirms the status of the State policy action commitments.         | <i>Link to the exact policy</i>                                                              |
| <b>Supporting Evidence: Attachments</b> | Upload State legislation attachments that confirm the status of State policy action commitments.              | <i>State Legislation attachment and/or URL.</i>                                              |
| <b>Notes and Comments</b>               | Provide any additional context or details around the status of the State policy action commitment, if needed. | <i>The bill was signed into law on July 15, 2026, and becomes effective January 1, 2027.</i> |

## 5. Use of Funds Reporting

The Use of Funds Form should be uploaded directly on this page using the “+ Add Use of Funds” button, as shown below. Refer to the **Obligated and Spent Funds Reporting**

**Guide** for detailed instructions on completing these forms. This form is a continuation of the Obligated and Spent Funds section of the Excel Reporting Template.

*Figure 26: Use of Funds*

MDCT  
RHTP

Rural Health  
Transformation Program

[Get Help](#)
[My Account](#)

{State: Name of the report submission}

[Last saved XX:XXpm](#)
[Leave form](#)

{Name of the report}

General Information

Initiative Attachments

Initiatives

State Policy Commitments

Use of Funds

Sustainability and Highlights

Review & Submit

## Use of Funds

Select "Add use of Funds" option below to attach the Use of Funds file for this reporting period.

[+ Add Use of Funds](#)

[< Previous](#)

[Continue >](#)

## 6. Sustainability and Highlights

On this page, qualitative updates on program successes and long-term sustainability planning may be shared.

Figure 27: Sustainability and Highlights

{State: Name of the report submission}

✓ Last saved XX:XXpm

{Name of the report}

General Information

Initiative Attachments

Initiatives

State Policy Commitments

Use of Funds

Sustainability and Highlights

Review & Submit

Sustainability and Highlights

Success Stories

Share success stories that you want to highlight as result of your State's implementation of the RHT Program.

Limit responses to 3,000 characters, approximately 400-500 words.

3,000 characters allowed

**Success Stories: Supporting Evidence** (Optional)

Upload supporting documentation (e.g., press releases illustrating success stories).

**Links**

Add URLs to supporting documentation.

+ Add link

**Attachments**

Upload supporting documentation.

+ Upload attachment

Figure 28: Changes to Sustainability Plan

What are the most significant updates or changes to your sustainability plan based on the past year's experiences, successes, and challenges?

Limit responses to 3,000 characters, approximately 400–500 words.

3,000 characters allowed

**Sustainability Planning: Supporting Evidence** (Optional)

Upload supporting documentation.

**Links**

Add URLs to supporting documentation.

+ Add link

**Attachments**

Upload supporting documentation.

+ Upload attachment

< Previous

Continue >

Figure 29 below outlines the relevant data fields on the Sustainability and Highlights page, along with instructions for completing each field and illustrative example values, where applicable. All examples are notional and provided for guidance only. **Please note, the examples are notional and should only be used as a guide.**

Figure 29: Sustainability and Highlights Page Instructions

| Data Field                     | Instructions                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Example                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Success Stories</b>         | <p>Share success stories that you want to highlight as a result of your State's implementation of the RHT Program.</p> <p><b>Please limit responses to 3,000 characters, approximately 400–500 words.</b></p> | <p><i>In a rural community with no local obstetrician, our new mobile health clinic (Initiative 1) provided prenatal care to 45 expectant mothers. One patient was able to receive all her prenatal checkups locally, avoiding a 3-hour round trip to the nearest city. This consistent care led to the early detection of a complication, ensuring a healthy delivery for both mother and baby.</i></p> |
| <b>Sustainability Planning</b> | <p>What are the most significant updates or changes to your sustainability plan based on the</p>                                                                                                              | <p><i>Based on the high demand for the mobile clinic, we have initiated discussions with the State Medicaid agency to establish a permanent</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

past year's experiences, successes, and challenges?

**Please limit responses to 3,000 characters, approximately 400–500 words.**

*reimbursement pathway for mobile health services. Furthermore, we have secured a partnership with the State University's nursing school to create a clinical rotation program on the mobile unit, which will provide a sustainable staffing pipeline and reduce future personnel costs.*

## 7. Review & Submit

On this final page, all previously entered report information is displayed for review prior to submission. Carefully review all components to ensure accuracy and completeness. Two submission actions are available within MDCT RHTP:

- **Submit for Review:** This option allows you to share a draft report with your PO for review and feedback. When you select this option, you may add an optional comment for your PO to convey what elements of your report you would like your PO to review. The MDCT RHTP will become locked for further edits until your PO completes their review and unlocks the report. Contact your PO if you need the report to be unlocked.
- **Submit Report:** This option indicates that the report is being formally submitted. Once **“Submit Report”** is selected, the report becomes locked for editing within the system for the remainder of the reporting period. Your report must be submitted using this action before the reporting deadline for each Annual and Quarterly report.

After formal submission, export your reporting package, including all submitted data and evidentiary documentation from the MDCT RHTP platform, and upload to GrantSolutions for official recordkeeping.

Prior to the submission deadline, States will compile and upload all respective materials into GrantSolutions for official recordkeeping. For this final submission to GrantSolutions, you should:

- Note that some evidentiary files will need to be converted to PDF format prior to uploading.
- Keep the exact same base file name used in your original files (e.g., if you uploaded the native file StateX\_Init\_1\_Checkpoint\_0.2.xlsx to the MDCT RHTP, upload the converted version to GrantSolutions as StateX\_Init\_1\_Checkpoint\_0.2.pdf).

Figure 30: Review and Submission

MDCT  
RHTP

Rural Health  
Transformation Program

Get Help

My Account

{State: Name of the report submission}

Last saved XX:XXpm

Leave form

{Name of the report}

General Information

Initiative Attachments

Initiatives

State Policy Commitments

Use of Funds

Sustainability and Highlights

Review & Submit

## Review & Submit

### Submit for Review

Select "Submit for Review" to send a notification to CMS that the report is ready for a preliminary review. States will still have edit functionality to complete the rest of the report until you have selected to fully "Submit" the report below.

Submit for Review

### Ready to Submit?

Double check that everything in your RHTP Report is accurate. Once you submit, you will only be able to make edits by contacting your CMS RHTP lead to unlock your report.

| Section                       | Status          |
|-------------------------------|-----------------|
| General Information           | <div>Edit</div> |
| Initiative Attachments        | <div>Edit</div> |
| Initiatives                   | <div>Edit</div> |
| State Policy Commitments      | <div>Edit</div> |
| Use of Funds                  | <div>Edit</div> |
| Sustainability and Highlights | <div>Edit</div> |
| Totals                        | <div>Edit</div> |

Review PDF

ZIP Attachment Files

Submit Report



## IX. Appendix

### A. Reporting Periods – Annual and Quarterly Reporting

Figure 31: Reporting Periods

| Report                                                                     | Reporting Period Start Date | Reporting Period End Date | Due Date          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Budget Period 1: December 29, 2025, to October 30, 2026 (10 months)</b> |                             |                           |                   |
| Annual Report # 1                                                          | December 29, 2025           | July 31, 2026             | August 30, 2026   |
| Quarterly Report # 1                                                       | August 1, 2026              | October 30, 2026          | November 29, 2026 |
| <b>Budget period 2: October 31, 2026, to October 30, 2027</b>              |                             |                           |                   |
| Quarterly Report # 2                                                       | October 31, 2026            | January 30, 2027          | March 1, 2027     |
| Quarterly Report # 3                                                       | January 31, 2027            | April 30, 2027            | May 30, 2027      |
| Annual Report # 2                                                          | August 1, 2026              | July 31, 2027             | August 30, 2027   |
| Quarterly Report # 4                                                       | August 1, 2027              | October 30, 2027          | November 29, 2027 |
| <b>Budget period 3: October 31, 2027, to October 30, 2028</b>              |                             |                           |                   |
| Quarterly Report # 5                                                       | October 31, 2027            | January 30, 2028          | February 29, 2028 |
| Quarterly Report # 6                                                       | January 31, 2028            | April 30, 2028            | May 30, 2028      |
| Annual Report # 3                                                          | August 1, 2027              | July 31, 2028             | August 30, 2028   |
| Quarterly Report # 7                                                       | August 1, 2028              | October 30, 2028          | November 29, 2028 |
| <b>Budget period 4: October 31, 2028, to October 30, 2029</b>              |                             |                           |                   |
| Quarterly Report # 8                                                       | October 31, 2028            | January 30, 2029          | March 1, 2029     |
| Quarterly Report # 9                                                       | January 31, 2029            | April 30, 2029            | May 30, 2029      |
| Annual Report # 4                                                          | August 1, 2028              | July 31, 2029             | August 30, 2029   |
| Quarterly Report # 10                                                      | August 1, 2029              | October 30, 2029          | November 29, 2029 |
| <b>Budget period 5: October 31, 2029, to October 30, 2030</b>              |                             |                           |                   |
| Quarterly Report # 11                                                      | October 31, 2029            | January 30, 2030          | March 1, 2030     |
| Quarterly Report # 12                                                      | January 31, 2030            | April 30, 2030            | May 30, 2030      |
| Annual Report # 5                                                          | August 1, 2029              | July 31, 2030             | August 30, 2030   |
| Quarterly Report # 13                                                      | August 1, 2030              | October 30, 2030          | November 29, 2030 |
| Final Report                                                               | December 29, 2025           | October 30, 2030          | February 27, 2031 |

### B. Resources

For additional information on RHT program reporting, please refer to the resources below.

1. [Rural Health Transformation \(RHT\) Program | CMS](#)
2. [Rural Health Transformation FAQ](#)

## C. State Progress Reporting Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Below are FAQs that cover the Annual and Quarterly Reports, reporting submission process, evidentiary documentation, and State reporting noncompliance.

### Reporting Submission Process (Initial Annual Reporting)

#### 1. How should States submit Annual Reports?

- a. During the initial program year (covering a 10-month period from 12/29/25 – 7/31/26), States will receive a standardized Excel Reporting Template to complete the first Annual Report (due August 30, 2026). For all subsequent reporting, the program will transition to a web-based interface. The platform will be deployed prior to the first quarterly reporting deadline.
- b. States should submit their completed Excel Reporting Template and evidentiary documentation by the reporting deadline via GrantSolutions.

### Evidentiary Documentation

#### 1. Do States have to provide evidentiary documentation?

- a. Yes, States are required to provide evidentiary documentation for each of the initiative checkpoints completed and for progress indicated for State policy action commitments.
- b. The type of evidentiary documentation that you should submit will vary depending on the checkpoint. Please refer to the Checkpoint Guidance tab in the Excel Reporting Template.

#### 2. How should States compile evidentiary documentation?

- a. Please refer to [Submitting Evidentiary Documentation](#) section for more information and examples of acceptable evidentiary documentation.

### State Reporting Non-Compliance

#### 1. What does it mean if a State fails to submit required reports?

- a. Per the Program Terms and Conditions, failure to submit required reports is considered a violation of the terms of the Cooperative Agreement.

#### 2. Is there an opportunity for States to address non-compliance before further action is taken?

- a. Yes. Per the Program Terms and Conditions, States will be issued a notice of non-compliance and provided a 90-day remediation period to correct the identified issues.

#### 3. What actions may CMS take if non-compliance is not remedied within the remediation period?

- a. If non-compliance is not resolved, CMS reserves the right to take one or more of the following actions as stated in the Program Terms and Conditions:
  - i. Recover previously issued payments.
  - ii. Withhold future payments, including both workload and baseline funding.

#### 4. Can non-compliance result in suspension or termination of the award?

- a. Yes. Per the Program Terms and Conditions, significant performance issues—such as misuse of funds or failure to carry out approved activities—may result in suspension or termination of the award. In such cases, the State would be ineligible for further funding until the non-compliance is resolved.
- b. Per the Program Terms and Conditions, at any time, CMS can decrease funding, recover funding, or terminate an award if a Recipient fails to fulfill the requirements of the award. The award may also otherwise be terminated to the extent authorized by law, if the agency determines the award no longer effectuates program goals or agency priorities.

## D. Table of Figures

|                                                                  |    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Figure 1: Initiative Form (Top) .....                            | 7  |
| Figure 2: Initiative Form (Bottom) .....                         | 8  |
| Figure 3: Initiative Form Instructions .....                     | 8  |
| Figure 4: State Policy Actions Form .....                        | 11 |
| Figure 5: State Policy Actions Form Instructions .....           | 12 |
| Figure 6: Success Stories .....                                  | 14 |
| Figure 7: Sustainability Planning .....                          | 14 |
| Figure 8: Rural Definition .....                                 | 15 |
| Figure 9: Additional Information Form Instructions .....         | 15 |
| Figure 10: General Information .....                             | 19 |
| Figure 11: General Information Instructions.....                 | 20 |
| Figure 12: Attachments.....                                      | 21 |
| Figure 13: Initiative Attachment Instructions .....              | 22 |
| Figure 14: Add Comments to Attachments .....                     | 23 |
| Figure 15: Upload Initiative Attachments.....                    | 23 |
| Figure 16: Add Attachments .....                                 | 23 |
| Figure 17: Editing Attachments.....                              | 24 |
| Figure 18: Viewing Attachment Comments.....                      | 25 |
| Figure 19: Initiatives .....                                     | 26 |
| Figure 20: Initiative Number/Name .....                          | 27 |
| Figure 21: Metrics .....                                         | 27 |
| Figure 22: Checkpoint Stages .....                               | 28 |
| Figure 23: Initiative Progress Instructions .....                | 28 |
| Figure 24: State Policy Commitments .....                        | 32 |
| Figure 25: State Policy Commitment Page Instructions .....       | 33 |
| Figure 26: Use of Funds.....                                     | 34 |
| Figure 27: Sustainability and Highlights.....                    | 35 |
| Figure 28: Changes to Sustainability Plan .....                  | 36 |
| Figure 29: Sustainability and Highlights Page Instructions ..... | 36 |
| Figure 30: Review and Submission.....                            | 38 |
| Figure 31: Reporting Periods.....                                | 39 |